

Summary of Conclusions for
Meeting of the NSC Principals Committee

DATE: November 22, 1995

LOCATION: White House Situation Room

TIME: 10:45 a.m. - 12:45 p.m.

SUBJECT: Summary of Conclusions of Principals Committee Meeting
on Bosnia ~~(S)~~

PARTICIPANTS:

THE PRESIDENT

THE VICE PRESIDENT

CHAIR

Anthony Lake

OVP

Leon Fuerth

State

Warren Christopher

Strobe Talbott

Richard Holbrooke

John Kornblum

Christopher Hill

DOD

Secretary Perry

Walter Slocumbe

James Pardew

USUN

Amb. Madeleine Albright

David Scheffer

OMB

Alice Rivlin

CIA

John Deutch

Dennis Blair

JCS

General Shalikashvili

LTG Wesley Clark

White House

Sandy Berger

Nancy Soderberg

NSC

Alexander Vershbow

BG Don Kerrick

Summary of Conclusions

1. Principals, joined by the President and Vice President for most of the meeting, were briefed by the U.S. delegation on the Dayton peace agreement signed the previous day and discussed follow-up. (U)

2. UNSC Resolutions: Principals agreed that the U.S. should insist on enactment of the UN Security Council resolution lifting the arms embargo before enactment of the resolution on suspension

~~SECRET~~

Classified by: Andrew Sens

Reason: 1.5 (a, b, d)

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of economic sanctions in order to ensure that the arms embargo lift was not blocked by Russia (Action USUN/State). ~~(C)~~

3. Bosnian Serb Compliance: Principals agreed that we need to press Serbian President Milosevic not only to secure Bosnian Serb initialing of the Dayton documents (pursuant to Milosevic's commitment to Secretary Christopher at Dayton), but to bring about early concrete manifestations of the Bosnian Serbs' compliance with the terms of the Dayton agreement; in this regard, we should warn Milosevic of our determination to reimpose economic sanctions if we do not see prompt indications that the Bosnian Serbs intend to implement the agreement (Action: State). The President stressed that we should not seek a Congressional vote of support for U.S. participation in IFOR until we are more convinced of Bosnian Serb strategic consent. ~~(C)~~

4. Equip and Train: Principals affirmed the U.S. commitment to the Bosnian Government at Dayton to ensure that Federation armed forces received the necessary equipping and training to establish an effective self-defense capability by the time IFOR leaves. They agreed that, to respond to the concerns within the USG and the Congress about the risk to U.S. forces, we will seek to ensure that the equip-and-train program is carried out by third countries, and we will seek to reduce the Federation's arms requirements to the maximum degree possible through a negotiated arms build-down. We should also make clear that U.S. support for an equip-and-train effort is dependent on Bosnia severing its military links to Iran (Action: State). ~~(S)~~

5. Congressional Strategy: Principals reviewed the gameplan for Congressional consultations in the period between the initialing of the peace agreement and the deployment of IFOR. The President and Vice President underscored in particular the need for DOD and JCS briefers to convey a clear message that IFOR's mission is limited and achievable, and that we will avoid mission creep (Action: All). Principals asked that a detailed IFOR mission statement be prepared as a common basis for Congressional briefings, together with a description of the end-state that we expect to be achieved at the end of IFOR's one-year deployment period (Action: JCS). ~~(C)~~

6. IFOR Enabling Force: Principals agreed that the U.S. should support a decision at NATO to proceed with the deployment of the IFOR enabling force, with the participation of U.S. forces, prior to the signature of the peace agreement in Paris in order to preserve the option of rapidly deploying the main force immediately after signature (Action: State/JCS). The President stressed the importance of full and thorough consultations with Congress on the enabling force (Action: NSC). ~~(C)~~

7. Russian Participation in IFOR: Principals reviewed plans for the November 28 Perry-Grachev meeting and reaffirmed U.S. readiness to agree to a 16+1 NATO-Russia consultative framework in the context of Russian agreement to place their forces under NATO operational or tactical control (Action: OSD/State). ~~(C)~~

8. Civilian Implementation: Principals agreed that the U.S. could support the appointment of Carl Bildt as High Representative for civilian implementation of the peace agreement if Bildt accepted an American as one of his senior deputies (Action: State). ~~(C)~~.

9. Funding: Principals discussed the implications for Bosnia funding of a possible Presidential veto of the Defense Appropriations bill. They agreed to explore with the Congress the possibility of using a portion of the \$7 billion not requested by the Administration as the means of funding U.S. forces in IFOR and the U.S. contribution to international economic reconstruction efforts (Action: OMB/OSD). ~~(C)~~

10. Sanctions: Principals agreed that it was essential to maintain the ICFY and SAM monitors in at least a stand-by capacity until the Bosnian elections in order to preserve the capability of reimposing sanctions if necessary (Action: OVP). ~~(C)~~

11. Decision Timeline: Principals asked the Deputies Committee to prepare a detailed timeline for political and military decisions over the coming weeks in order to permit Principals to decide the best date for the Congressional vote and the signing of the peace agreement in Paris (Action: NSC). ~~(C)~~

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